

TEACH

TEAMS & MEETINGS

FOR INTACT TEAMS

The Friction Forecast

A guide to the predictable friction between orientations, readable from the team map. **What looks like a personality clash is usually orientation friction**, and friction you can forecast, you can design around.

THE DRAIN

Cross-orientation friction gets misdiagnosed as interpersonal conflict, and the misdiagnosis is expensive: mediation where design was needed, "communication workshops" for what is actually a handoff structure problem, and two capable people each privately concluding the other is difficult.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The forecast catalogs the recurring friction signatures between orientations, where each one predictably appears in a workflow, and the design move that dissolves it. Read alongside the team map, it converts "those two don't get along" into "that handoff is missing a contract," which is a solvable problem.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Map your team's live frictions to the catalog.** Most "difficult pairs" match a signature within minutes of looking.
- 2 Rename them out loud.** "This is the pace-depth friction, not a you-two problem" changes the temperature of the room immediately.
- 3 Install the design fix.** Every signature has one. Structure resolves what conversation alone keeps re-fighting.
- 4 Teach the catalog to the team.** A team that can name its frictions in orientation language stops taking them personally.

The classic frictions

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|----------|---------------------------------|--|
| 1 | The vision handoff stall | WHY energy hands WHAT-shaped goals to HOW wiring with the mechanism missing. Fix: the Handoff Contract. |
| 2 | Pace versus depth | WHAT energy reads HOW thoroughness as resistance; HOW reads the pace as recklessness. Fix: agreed thresholds, Tool 11. |
| 3 | The reopened decision | WHY energy revisits what WHAT considered closed. Fix: the Decision Deadline log, pointed to, not argued. |
| 4 | Precision as obstruction | The edge-case question lands as negativity at the moment of momentum. Fix: the scheduled precision pass, Tool 35. |

WHAT IT WON'T DO

Not all conflict is orientation friction; genuine interpersonal and performance issues exist, and dressing them in framework language delays dealing with them. The forecast covers the large fraction that is structural, and an honest facilitator names which fraction they are looking at.

IN THE KIT

Friction signature catalog

Team mapping worksheet

Design-fix quick reference

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 37 Team MindPrint™ Map · **Tool 42** The Handoff Contract · **Tool 35** Orientation-Balanced Agenda